

basketball, shooting games, and others.

After watching a demonstration of the Magnavox Odyssey, which also included Tennis, Bushnell wanted to produce an arcade version of tennis, which would be

called *Pong*. Bushnell and Tabney wanted to incorporate a company under the name Syzygy, but found that a candle company in California already had that name.



The world's first home video game—the Magnavox Odyssey—which inspired the creation of *Pong*

The Atari Story

Following the Pong home console's popularity, many clones tried to enter the market, but weren't successful. The major ones were Coleco's

Telstar and Magnavox's Odyssey 100 (an improved Odyssey).



Home video gaming picked up with the Atari 2600

Later, in early 1976, the MOS (Metal-Oxide Semiconductor) Technology 6502, an 8-bit microprocessor, was released. It offered high performance at low cost. Using this processor, Atari released the Atari VCS (Video Console System), later renamed the Atari 2600. It employed cartridges. That move helped the Atari 2600 become the most successful console in video game console history.

The enthusiasm for home video consoles slowly waned; later in 1976, Bushnell sold Atari Inc. to Warner Communications. Two years later, he left Atari. In 1977 began the second generation of video game consoles.